

The IP Monetization Checklist

7 Questions Every Energy Executive Should Ask About Their Technology Assets

By Victor Omoniyi (Mister O.) · IP Licensing & Technology Commercialization · victoromoniyi.com

Most energy companies don't know what their technology assets are worth - or whether they're even protected. After 7+ years structuring IP licensing deals inside one of the world's largest energy companies, I've identified the seven questions that separate organizations that monetize their technology from those that leave billions on the table.

Work through each question honestly. If you can't answer it, that's your gap.

01 Do you know what technology assets your organization actually owns?

Not just patents - algorithms, datasets, models, workflows, and know-how

Why it matters: Most organizations can tell you how many patents they have. Very few can tell you what their AI systems, proprietary datasets, and digital tools are worth commercially. If you don't have a complete asset inventory, you can't monetize what you don't know you own.

02 Are your AI and digital assets legally protected?

Copyright, trade secret, patent, or contractual protection?

Why it matters: AI-generated outputs and trained models don't fit neatly into traditional IP frameworks. Before you show your technology to any external party, you need to know exactly what is protected and how. One careless demonstration can compromise your IP position permanently.

03 Have you assessed the commercial value of your technology assets?

Not cost-to-build - market value. What would a licensee actually pay?

Why it matters: There is a significant difference between what it cost to build a technology and what the market will pay to license it. Without a market-facing valuation, you are negotiating blind - and almost certainly leaving money on the table.

04 Do you know who the right licensees are for your technology assets?

Competitors, suppliers, adjacent industries, academic institutions?

Why it matters: The right licensee is not always obvious. A predictive maintenance algorithm built for oil & gas may be more valuable to a mining company or a utility than to a competitor. Identifying the right partner is as important as identifying the right asset.

05 Do you have a royalty framework in place?

Fixed fee, running royalty, milestone payments, or hybrid?

Why it matters: Royalty structure determines how much value you actually capture from a licensing deal. The wrong structure - even on a strong asset - can result in dramatically undervalued agreements. Most organizations default to whatever the other party proposes.

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Is there executive sponsorship for technology commercialization?

Does leadership treat commercialization as a priority or an afterthought?

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Why it matters: No licensing deal closes without senior-level commitment. If technology commercialization is not tied to performance metrics, budget, and executive accountability, it will always be deprioritized in favor of operational goals.

Do you have someone who speaks both the IP and commercial language?

Not just lawyers. Not just business developers. Someone who bridges both.

07

Why it matters: The gap between what energy companies own and what they monetize almost always comes down to this: the IP function and the commercial function operate in different rooms. The person who can sit in the middle - fluent in both languages - is where deals get done.

HOW TO USE YOUR RESULTS

5-7 questions answered confidently: You have the foundation. The opportunity is to optimize and accelerate.

3-4 questions answered confidently: You have gaps that are costing you revenue. A structured assessment will identify the highest-value opportunities.

0-2 questions answered confidently: Your organization has significant unlicensed value sitting idle. The gap is large - and so is the opportunity.

Want to close the gap? Let's talk.

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Available for speaking engagements, advisory retainers, and consulting engagements in IP strategy, AI monetization, and technology commercialization.